

Absolutely — **tart** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “They are especially known for their sourdough bread, **egg tarts**, and seasonal desserts.”

Here **tart** means **a baked pastry with a shallow pastry case and a filling**. But the word also has important meanings as an adjective meaning **sharp/sour in taste**, and figuratively **sharp or cutting in tone**.

Word family: **tart**

Base word: tart

Plural: tarts

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **tart** = pastry with filling — 撻；餡餅類糕點

Your phrase:

> “egg **tarts**”

Here **tart** means:

> **a small or large baked pastry with a shallow pastry case and a filling, often sweet.**

繁體中文：

以酥皮 / 糕點皮作底或外殼，內有餡料的烘焙糕點；撻

Natural translation:

> “egg tarts”

「**蛋撻**」

So here:

> **tart** = 撻類糕點

1. **tart** = pastry with an open filling — 撻；餡撻

The core noun meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The bakery is known for its egg **tarts**.”

「這間麵包店以**蛋撻**聞名。」

Practice 2

> “She baked a lemon **tart**.”

「她焗了一個檸檬**撻**。」

Practice 3

> “The fruit tart was served cold.”

「水果**撻**是冷食的。」

tart = 以酥皮 / 糕點皮作底，通常上面不完全封閉、內有餡料的烘焙食品

2. **tart** = small individual pastry — 小撻；迷你撻

Practice 4

> “She bought two chocolate **tarts**.”

「她買了兩個朱古力**小撻**。」

Practice 5

> “The café serves individual fruit tarts.”

「這間咖啡店供應單人份水果**小撻**。」

a tart = 一個可單獨食用的撻類糕點

This is still the same food sense, just countability/size.

3. **tart** = sharp/sour in taste — 酸的；帶尖銳酸味的

A major adjective meaning.

Practice 6

> “The berries are quite **tart**.”

「這些莓果味道很**酸**。」

Practice 7

> “The sauce has a slightly tart flavour.”

「這個醬汁帶有一點**酸味**。」

tart — taste = 酸味明顯、帶一點尖銳感，但不一定難吃

This is often more refined than simply **sour**.

4. **tart = pleasantly sharp / tangy — 酸香的；帶清爽酸味的**

A useful positive taste nuance.

Practice 8

> “The lemon filling is sweet but **tart**.”

「檸檬餡甜中帶**清爽酸味**。」

Practice 9

> “The yogurt has a fresh, tart taste.”

「這款乳酪帶有清新的**酸香味**。」

tart = 酸得明顯但可以是令人愉快、清爽、開胃的

So **tart** does not automatically mean unpleasant.

5. **tart = sharp / cutting in tone — 尖刻的；刻薄的**

A major figurative adjective sense.

Practice 10

> “She gave a **tart** reply.”

「她給了一個**尖刻的回答**。」

Practice 11

> “His tart comment made everyone uncomfortable.”

「他那句**刻薄 / 尖銳的評論**令大家不舒服。」

****tart — tone = 說話語氣尖銳、帶諷刺或不客氣****

This is a genuine figurative extension from “sharp taste” to “sharp language”.

6. ****tart = sharp/witty in style — 辛辣的；犀利的****

A more literary/review-style extension.

Practice 12

> “The article contains some ****tart observations**** about modern life.”

「文章對現代生活有一些****辛辣犀利的觀察****。」

Practice 13

> “Her writing is elegant but tart.”

「她的文筆優雅，但也帶點****辛辣 / 尖銳****。」

****tart = 表達方式機智但帶刺、犀利、不完全溫和****

Register:

* literary

* review/commentary style

7. ****tartness = sourness / sharpness — 酸味；尖銳感****

A useful related noun.

Practice 14

> “The sugar balances the **tartness** of the fruit.”

「糖分平衡了水果的**酸味**。」

Practice 15

> “There was a tartness in her voice.”

「她的語氣中帶著一種**尖刻感**。」

tartness = 味道上的酸銳感；也可比喻語氣上的尖刻

Important distinction: **tart vs pie**

tart

usually:

- * shallow
- * often open-topped
- * pastry base/case

pie

usually:

- * deeper
- * may have pastry top and bottom
- * filling often enclosed

> tart = 撻

> pie = 批 / 派

But regional bakery usage can vary.

Important distinction: **tart vs pastry**

You just curated **pastry**.

pastry

= the dough/material or broader pastry category.

tart

= a specific baked item made with pastry and filling.

So:

> tart is a kind of pastry item.

Important distinction: **tart vs cake**

tart

= pastry shell + filling.

cake

= usually batter-based baked sweet.

> lemon tart

> = 檸檬撻

> lemon cake

> = 檸檬蛋糕

Different structure.

Important distinction: **tart vs sour**

sour

= acidic taste, can be unpleasant or simply descriptive.

tart

= sharp acidic taste, often fresher/more appetizing in food writing.

> sour milk

> = 酸壞了的牛奶

> tart berries

> = 酸香的莓果

So **tart** is often more positive/culinary.

Important distinction: **tart vs tangy**

tangy

= pleasantly sharp/zesty.

tart

= noticeably acidic/sharp.

> tangy sauce

> = 酸香開胃的醬汁

> tart lemon filling

> = 酸味明顯的檸檬餡

They overlap, but **tangy** often sounds more lively/positive.

Important distinction: **tart vs bitter**

tart

= 酸

bitter

= 苦

These are different taste dimensions.

A grapefruit can be:

* tart

* bitter

* both

depending on part and preparation.

Important distinction: ****tart — taste vs tone****

Taste:

> “The fruit is tart.”

= 水果很酸。

Tone:

> “Her reply was tart.”

= 她的回答很尖刻。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: ****tart comment vs rude comment****

****tart****

= sharp, cutting, often witty.

****rude****

= impolite.

A tart comment may be witty and indirect, while a rude comment can be bluntly impolite.

Important distinction: ****tart vs sarcastic****

****tart****

= sharp/biting tone.

****sarcastic****

= uses irony/mockery.

A tart remark may be sarcastic, but not all tart remarks rely on sarcasm.

Important note on polysemy depth

Tart has a compact but strong modern inventory.

The genuinely useful senses are mainly:

1. **tart** = pastry
2. **tart** = sharp/sour taste
3. **tart** = sharp/cutting tone

Then:

* tartness
* egg tart
* fruit tart
are family/compound extensions, not separate core senses.

We should not over-split every type of tart.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **tart** — pastry = 撻
* **tart** — sharp/sour taste = 酸的 / 酸香的
* **tart** — sharp tone = 尖刻的 / 刻薄的
* **tart** — witty/sharp style = 辛辣 / 犀利的
* **tartness** — taste = 酸味
* **tartness** — tone = 尖刻感
* **egg tart** = 蛋撻
* **fruit tart** = 水果撻
* **lemon tart** = 檸檬撻

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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tart — pastry	以酥皮 / 糕點皮作底或外殼、內有餡料的烘焙糕點
tart — taste	酸味明顯、帶尖銳酸感的
tart — pleasant sharp taste	帶清爽、開胃酸味的
tart — tone	說話尖銳、帶諷刺或不客氣的

tart — style	表達機智但帶刺、辛辣犀利的	
tartness — taste	食物中的酸銳味	
tartness — tone	語氣中的尖刻 / 尖銳感	

For your original phrase

> “They are especially known for their sourdough bread, **egg tarts**, and seasonal desserts.”

The exact meaning is:

tart = 蛋撻這種以酥皮 / 糕點皮作外殼、裡面有蛋奶餡的烘焙糕點。

Natural translation:

> **「他們尤其以酸種麵包、蛋撻和季節限定甜品而聞名。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **egg tart** → 蛋撻

> **fruit tart** → 水果撻

> **tart berries** → 酸味明顯的莓果

> **tart flavour** → 酸香味

> **tart reply** → 尖刻回答

> **tart comment** → 辛辣 / 刻薄評論

> **tart vs sour** → 酸香 / 尖銳酸味 vs 一般酸味